

Throwback occurrence. Price throws back to the breakout price (or comes close to it) almost twice in every three trades. It takes price a dozen days to make the round-trip and half that time to see price rise an average of 5% (before starting on the return journey).

Patterns *without* throwbacks, which see upward momentum work for them, perform better than do those with throwbacks. That's typical behavior. After a throwback completes, price resumes, rising nearly all of the time, except for the stock you own. Doesn't it seem to work like that?

Gaps. Cups with breakout day gaps don't see the kind of boost traders expect (only one percentage point between gaps and no gaps).

[Table 21.5](#) shows pattern size statistics.

Height. Here's where things get weird. Most patterns see tall patterns outperform short ones, but not cups. It's the reverse. I measured the height of the pattern from highest peak to lowest valley and divided by the breakout price (the highest peak). If the result was bigger than the median shown in the table, then the cup-with-handle pattern was tall.

Width. Patterns narrower than the median width shown in the table outperformed by a substantial amount. Usually wider patterns show a small performance edge over narrow ones, but not with cups. Width includes both the rounded cup and the handle.

Height and width combinations. We've seen that short cups outperform and narrow cups outperform, so you'd expect the combination of short and narrow cups, on average, to be the best performers. Nooo! Tall and narrow ones do best. Short and narrow places second. In last place are cups both tall and wide (which is usually the best performer).

[Table 21.6](#) shows volume-related statistics.

Volume trend. Volume trends downward most of the time, but the result is not far from random. Does the trend direction really matter?

Rising/Falling volume. The answer to the above question is no. The performance difference between cups with a rising volume and those with receding volume is two percentage points. That's probably because the pattern is so wide that any volume pattern will appear irregular. Linear